

Reference: 756622

Jerin John
Information Rights Adviser
Information.requests@ofcom.org.uk

6 September 2019

Roger Howell
request-596532-514dd2d6@whatdotheyknow.com

Dear Mr Howell,

Freedom of Information: Right to know request

Thank you for your request for information about issued and available UK amateur radio callsign formats.

This was received by Ofcom on 12 August and it has been considered under the Freedom of Information Act 2000 ("the Act").

Your request

You asked:

Please provide a dataset of every valid UK radio amateur callsign, the licence class, and its current issue status (for example but not limited to: allocated, reserved, available, forbidden, otherwise unavailable for a new licence application).

Alternatively, please provide the relevant data that would be enable the derivation of such a dataset. I believe that such data would include at minimum:

- 1) a list of all valid formats with corresponding licence class,*
- 2) a list of all forbidden suffixes, and*
- 3) a list of all currently reserved/allocated callsigns.*

If there are any cases where a callsign meets the valid formats in (1), is not a forbidden callsign (2), and is not reserved/allocated (3) but is still unavailable to be issued, please provide details of the rules and/or restrictions that apply.

Our response

Information regarding amateur radio callsign is available on our website under “Amateur radio callsign allocation”: https://www.ofcom.org.uk/manage-your-licence/radiocommunication-licences/amateur-radio/amateur-radio-info#accordion_target-86290.

We hold a list of allocated and reserved (as defined below) callsigns together with their respective class. Please find attached an annex listing the amateur radio callsigns which are either allocated or reserved as at the date of your request together with their class.

To further clarify the status categorisation:

- ‘Allocated’ means that the callsign is currently assigned to a station under an amateur radio licence. It is therefore not currently available for assignment to anyone else.
- ‘Reserved’ means that the callsign has been used within the past two years, although it is no longer, and is in the process of ‘cooling down’. It is therefore not currently available for assignment to anyone else, but operators will be able to apply for it again after the two-year period has expired.

We also hold information on forbidden callsigns suffixes, a list of which is also set out in the attached annex under the “Forbidden Call Signs” tab.

We do not hold a comprehensive list of all callsigns that are “available”. If a callsign is not allocated, reserved or on the list of forbidden callsigns, and, if it also complies with our call sign format rules (as published under ‘Amateur Radio call sign allocation’, on our website here:

<https://www.ofcom.org.uk/manage-your-licence/radiocommunication-licences/amateur-radio/amateur-radio-info>), it is by default available to be assigned to a qualifying amateur radio station at the corresponding level (Foundation, Intermediate or Full), for a new licence application.

I hope this information is useful. If you have any queries, please contact information.requests@ofcom.org.uk. Please remember to quote the reference number above in any future communications.

Yours sincerely,

Jerin John

If you are unhappy with the response or level of service you have received in relation to your request from Ofcom, you may ask for an internal review. If you ask us for an internal review of our decision, it will be treated as a formal complaint and will be subject to an independent review within Ofcom. We will acknowledge the complaint and inform you of the date by which you might expect to be told the outcome.

The following outcomes are possible:

- the original decision is upheld; or
- the original decision is reversed or modified.

Timing

If you wish to exercise your right to an internal review **you should contact us within two months of the date of this letter**. There is no statutory deadline for undertaking internal reviews and it will depend upon the complexity of the case. However, we aim to conclude all such reviews within 20 working days, and up to 40 working days in exceptional cases. We will keep you informed of the progress of any such review. If you wish to request an internal review, you should contact:

Corporation Secretary
Ofcom
Riverside House
2a Southwark Bridge Road
London SE1 9HA

If you are not content with the outcome of the internal review, you have the right to apply directly to the Information Commissioner for a decision. The Information Commissioner can be contacted at:

Information Commissioner's Office
Wycliffe House
Water Lane
Wilmslow
Cheshire
SK9 5AF